THE SURVEY

OF

WESTERN PALESTINE.

MEMOIRS

OF THE

TOPOGRAPHY, OROGRAPHY, HYDROGRAPHY,

AND

ARCHÆOLOGY.

BY

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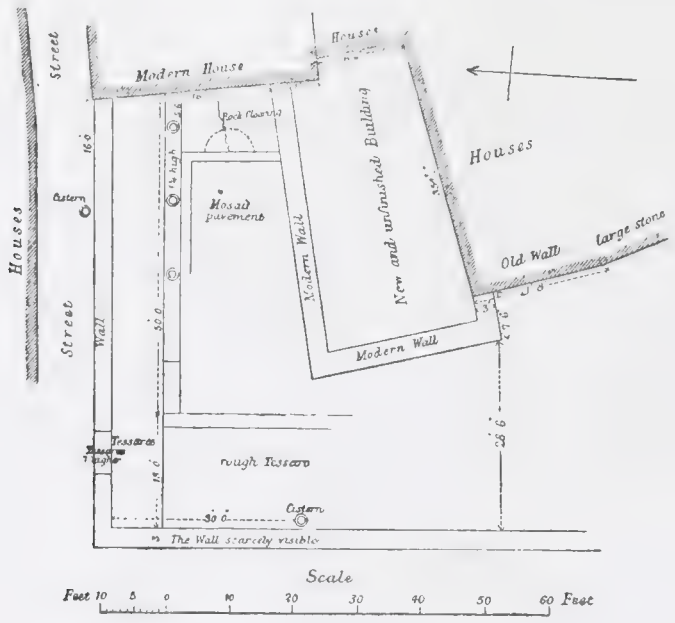
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'Anâta (N t).—West of the village are remains of a colonnaded building; bearing 103° Mag. The north wall, just south of the street, is 3 feet thick, and extends 90 feet; 8½ feet south of the inside of this wall



is a row of pillar bases, three remaining, and south of this a mosaic pavement well preserved. This building appears to be a church. A modern house has been built over the east end.

Visited October, 1873.

El 'Anazîyeh (L s).—Traces of ruins. A cave with a cross cut on the wall. On the east side of the valley, south-east of this ruin, is a small spring.

El 'Aneizîyeh (K t).—A small ruined building above the road, apparently modern.

'Attâra (M s).—A high isolated hill, with ruins to the south at its foot, and two ancient reservoirs on the slope, near which are rock-cut tombs. The hill is called Tell en Nasbeh, and has a spring ('Ain Jâdy) to the south-east. The first tank is rock-cut, with a cemented wall on one side (east). The second, to the north-east, is much ruined; it had

rock-cut steps on the north-west and a wall on the east. The principal reservoir measures 78 feet by 37 feet, the wall 9 feet thick with 4 internal buttresses. The outlet has a pointed arch. The core of the wall is of rubble; the ashlar facing is irregular, the cement very hard. Ruined buildings with arches slightly pointed, walls, and heaps of stone occur in other parts of the site. Caves, cisterns and tombs occur, and the site is that of a ruined town. One tomb has a façade, with niches for many lamps. The sides of the Tell are quarried, as also those of the hill to the west.

'Aslîn (J t).—Remains of a ruined village, with a Mukâm.

Beit 'Atâb (K t).

This place is identified by Captain Conder (see Section A) with Etam. Guérin has an interesting note upon it. He found that the Sheikh's house, with the adjoining houses, is built upon the site of an old fort, some vaults of which remain, and seemed to him older than the Crusades. The people say that there is a subterranean passage from the castle to the spring at the bottom of the hill. They also told him that the village of Eshua (4 miles to the north-west) was formerly called Ashtual, and that between the villages of Sŭr'ah and Eshua is a wâly consecrated to the Sheikh Gherib, and known also as the Kabr Shamshûn, Tomb of Samson.

Beit Erza (M u).—This is a ruin west of Sherâfât: rock-cut cisterns exist at it, caves, a broken tomb, vaults with groined roofs, and other remains, apparently of Crusading and later work.

Beit Fajûs (K t).—Ruins of a small village, with a spring to the south and a Mukâm. There are remains of a vaulted building, apparently not very ancient.

Beit Fased (J u).—Foundations, cisterns, caves, heaps of stones, and two or three rock-cut tombs.

Beit Ika (K u).—Traces of ruins and gardens.

Beit Lahm (M u).—The church is interesting as being the only basilica of Constantine's left standing in Palestine. The atrium is destroyed, but the basilica, consisting of a nave and four aisles, is almost intact, the original columns and the clerestory walls, with fragments of glass mosaic (of twelfth century) remaining. The basilica measures 87 feet east and west, by 75 feet north and south. At the east end is a transept, with north and south apses, and an east apse of equal size. The floor of the transept is raised for a width